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Design Thinking

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Seven Days of Roller Coaster

I had never built a roller coaster in my life, and this project was definitely challenging at first. What disappointed me somehow was the fact that I had to join another team. They had already decided on the theme and structure, so it made me sad that I could not contribute to their ideation process. However, as I got to hear their idea of recreating the movie *Ratatouille*, it made me excited for what would come next. It was interesting that we were able to quickly decide how the movie story would transform in our roller coaster, and we ended up sticking to our whole idea as we proceeded. The most challenging part of the project was bringing the whole team together. Our times wouldn't always align; however, each team member made sure that they contributed something each time they came to the couch room. Besides, it was quite hard to cut the foamcore in shape as expected, because it was too hard and dense. For example, when I was trying to make a circle shape, it turned out to be awkward, leaving me frustrated for a moment.

One of the advantages of working in a team was that it pushed me to see a point in the eyes of another team member. I really tried to see their point of view and how they wanted the story to evolve in the roller coaster. However, there was a moment when I felt tension; when I built a little design for the part, one team member destroyed it, leaving me feeling hurt. I could not rationalize why she did that, and I felt uncomfortable to step in and ask. Though I believe there can always be unspoken expectations when working together, and I just moved on at that

time. Next time, I hope to ask explicitly what the other team member thinks I have done wrong and seek for improvement.

My favorite part of the process was designing the roller coaster, because it is my strength to draw and design little things, like a chef hat and food. These are three learnings that I would like to take with me: sometimes discipline is more important than waiting for creativity; unspoken expectations exist and ask them out loud; presentation of the project is as important as building it. Finally, I believe that each team member contributed equally to the roller coaster, and maybe my contribution is 5% off due to the fact that I joined them later.